GEN 2.2 Abbreviations used in AIS publications

ICAO abbreviations shall be used in the aeronautical information services whenever they are appropriate and their use will facilitate distribution of aeronautical data and aeronautical information.

~	*Differences from ICAO Abbreviations (Doc 8400)*
†	*When radiotelephony is used, the abbreviations and terms are transmitted as spoken words.*
‡	*When radiotelephony is used, the abbreviations and terms are transmitted using the individual letters in non-phonetic form.*
*	*Signal is also available for use in communicating with stations of the maritime mobile service.*
#	*Signal for use in the teletypewriter service only.*

A

A~	Abbreviated VASI
A	Amber
AAA	*(or AAB, AAC...etc.. in sequence) Amended meteorological message (message type designator)*
A/A	Air-to-air
AAD	Assigned altitude deviation
AAIM	Aircraft autonomous integrity monitoring
AAL	Above aerodrome level
AAR	Air to air refuelling
ABI	Advanced boundary information
ABM	Abeam
ABN	Aerodrome beacon
ABT	About
ABV	Above
AC	Altocumulus
ACARS†	*(to be pronounced "AY-CARS")* Aircraft communication addressing and reporting system
ACAS†	Airborne collision avoidance system
ACC‡	Area control centre *or* area control
ACCID	Notification of an aircraft accident
ACFT	Aircraft
ACK	Acknowledge
ACL	Altimeter check location
ACN	Aircraft classification number
ACP	Acceptance *(message type designator)*
ACPT	Accept or accepted
ACSA~	Airports Company South Africa
ACT	Active *or* activated *or* activity
AD	Aerodrome
ADA	Advisory area
ADC	Aerodrome chart
ADDN	Addition *or* additional
ADF‡	Automatic direction-finding equipment
ADIZ†	(*to be pronounced "AY-DIZ")* Air defence identification zone
ADJ	Adjacent
ADO	Aerodrome office *(specify service)*
ADR	Advisory route
ADS*	The address *(when this abbreviation is used to request a repetition, the question mark (IMI) precedes the abbreviation, e.g. IMI ADS (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*

ADS-B‡	Automatic dependent surveillance - broadcast
ADS-C‡	Automatic dependent surveillance - contract
ADSU	Automatic dependent surveillance unit
ADVS	Advisory service
ADZ	Advise
AES	Aircraft earth station
AFIL	Flight plan filed in the air
AFIS	Aerodrome flight information service
AFM	Yes *or* affirm *or* affirmative *or* that is correct
AFS	Aeronautical fixed service
AFT ...	After...*(time or place)*
AFTN‡	Aeronautical fixed telecommunication network
A/G	Air-to-ground
AGA	Aerodrome, air routes and ground aids
AGL	Above ground level
AGN	Again
AIC	Aeronautical information circular
AIDC	Air traffic services interfacility data communications
AIM	Aeronautical information management
AIP	Aeronautical Information publication
AIP SUP	AIP supplement
AIRAC	Aeronautical information regulation and control
AIREP†	Air-report
AIRMET†	Information concerning en-route weather phenomena which may affect the safety of low level aircraft operations
AIS	Aeronautical information services
ALA	Alighting area
ALERFA†	Alert phase
ALR	Alerting *(message type designator)*
ALRS	Alerting service
ALS	Approach lighting system
ALSF-1~	Approach light systems with sequenced flashing lights in CAT 1 Configuration.
ALSF-2~	Approach light system with red barrettes and sequenced flashing lights.
ALT	Altitude
ALTN	Alternate *or* alternating (*light alternates in colour)*
ALTN	Alternate *(aerodrome)*
Am~	Amber
AMA	Area minimum altitude
AMATIS~	AMHS Agent Terminal Interface System
AMD	Amend *or* amended *(used to indicate amended meteorological message; message type designator)*
AMDT	Amendment *(AIP Amendment)*
AMHS~	Aeronautical Message Handling System
AMS	Aeronautical mobile service
AMSL	Above mean sea level
AMSS	Aerodrome mobile satellite service
ANAIS~	Aeronautical Automated Information System
ANC	Aeronautical chart - 1:500 000 *(followed by name/title)*
ANCS...	Aeronautical navigation chart - small scale *(followed by name/ title and scale)*

ANS	Answer
AOC...	Aerodrome obstacle chart *(followed by type and name/title)*
AO	Aircraft operator
AP	Airport
APAPI†	*(to be pronounced "AY-PAPI")* Abbreviated precision approach path indicator
APCH	Approach
APDC...	Aircraft parking/docking chart *(followed by name/title)*
APN	Apron
APP	Approach control office *or* approach control *or* approach control service
APR	April
APRX	Approximate *or* approximately
APSG	After passing
APU	Auxiliary power unit
APV	Approach procedure with vertical guidance
ARC	Area chart
ARNG	Arrange
ARO	Air traffic services reporting office
ARP	Aerodrome reference point
ARP	Air-report *(message type designator)*
ARQ	Automatic error correction
ARR	Arrival *(message type designator)*
ARR	Arrive *or* arrival
ARS	Special air-report *(message type designator*)
ARST	Arresting *(specify (part of) aircraft arresting equipment)*
AS	Altostratus
ASAP	As soon as possible
ASC	Ascent to *or* ascending to
ASDA	Accelerate-stop distance available
ASE	Altimetry system error
ASHTAM	Special series of NOTAM notifying, by means of a specific format, change in activity of a volcano, a volcanic eruption and/ or volcanic ash cloud that is of significance to aircraft operations
ASPH	Asphalt
AT...	At *(followed by time at which weather change is forecast to occur)*
ATA‡	Actual time of arrival
ATC‡	Air traffic control *(in general)*
ATCSMAC...	Air traffic control surveillance minimum altitude chart *(followed by name/title)*.
ATD‡	Actual time of departure
ATFM	Air traffic flow management
ATIS†	Automatic terminal Information service
ATM	Air traffic management
ATN	Aeronautical telecommunication network
ATP...	At… *(time or place)*
ATS	Air traffic services
ATSU~	Air Traffic Service Unit
ATTN	Attention
AT-VASIS†	*(to be pronounced "AY-TEE-VASIS")* Abbreviated T visual approach slope indicator system
ATZ	Aerodrome traffic zone
AUG	August
AUTH	Authorized *or* authorization
AUTO	Automatic
AUW	All up weight
AUX	Auxiliary

AVBL	Available *or* availability
AVG	Average
AVGAS†	Aviation gasoline
AWOS	Automated Weather Observing System
AWTA	Advise at what time able
AWY	Airway
AZM	Azimuth
B	
(B)~	Bi-directional
B~	Bar
B	Blue
BA	Braking action
BARO-VNAV†	*(to be pronounced "BAA-RO - VEE-NAV")* Barometric vertical navigation
BASE†	Cloud base
BCFG	Fog patches
BCN	Beacon *(Aeronautical ground light)*
BCST	Broadcast
BDRY	Boundary
BECMG	Becoming
BFR	Before
BKN	Broken
BL...	Blowing *(followed by DU-dust, SA=sand or SN=snow)*
BLDG	Building
BLO	Below clouds
BLW	Below...
BOMB	Bombing
BR	Mist
BRF	Short *(used to indicate the type of approach desired, or required)*
BRG	Bearing
BRKG	Braking
BS	Commercial broadcasting station
BTL	Between layers
BTN	Between
BUFR	Binary universal form for the representation of meteorological data
C	
...C	Centre *(preceded by runway designation number to identify a parallel runway)*
C	Degrees Celsius *(Centigrade)*
CA	Course to an altitude
CAA	Civil Aviation Authority *or* Civil Aviation Administration
CALVERT~	Configuration and -2 indicating Cat 2 configuration. Barrettes inner 1000 ft *(305 m)*.
CAMU~	Central Airspace Management Unit
CAT	Category
CAT	Clear air turbulence
CAVOK†	*(to be pronounced "KAV-OH-KAY")* Visibility, cloud and present weather better than prescribed values or conditions
CB~	Automatic dependent surveillance - broadcast *(details)* ads-b
CB‡	*(to be pronounced "CEE BEE")* Cumulonimbus
CBP~	Cloud Break Procedure
CC~	Automatic dependent surveillance - contract *(details)* ads-c
CC	Cirrocumulus
CCA	*(or CCB, CCC...etc. in sequence)* Corrected meteorological message *(message type designator)*
CCO	Continuous climb operations

CCT~	Circuit
CD	Candela
CD~	Coded
CD~	Controller-pilot data link communications *(details)* cpdlc
CD5B~	Coded approach light system with 5 bars suffix -1 for CAT ILS 1.
CDN	Co-ordination *(message type designator)*
CDO	Continuous descent operations
CDR	Conditional route
CF	Change frequency to...
CF	Course to a fix
CFM*	Confirm *or* I confirm *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
CGL	Circling guidance light(s)
CH	Channel
CH#	This is a channel-continuity-check of transmission to permit comparison of your record of channel-sequence numbers of messages received on the channel *(to be used in AFS as per procedure signal)*
CHEM	Chemical
CHF~	Aerodrome Authority
CHG	Modification *(message type designator)*
CI	Cirrus
CIDIN†	Common ICAO data interchange network
CIV	Civil
CK	Check
CL	Centre Line
CL30M~	Centreline. The figures indicate the spacing between lights when known.
CL4B~	Centreline with 4 bars *(single row not coded)* Prefixed by "B" indicates bar centreline.
CLA	Clear type of ice formation
CLBR	Calibration
CLCD~	Coded centreline. White, alternative white and red, red.
CLD	Cloud
CLD~	Configuration deviation list
CLG	Calling
CLIMB-OUT	Climb-out area
CLR	Clear(s) *or* cleared to... *or* clearance
CLRD	Runway (s) cleared *(used in METAR/SPECI)*
CLSD	Close *or* closed *or* closing
CM	Centimeter
CMB	Climb to *or* climbing to
CMPL	Completion *or* completed *or* complete
CNL	Cancel *or* cancelled
CNL	Flight plan cancellation *(message type designator)*
CNS	Communication, navigation and surveillance
COM	Communications
CONC	Concrete
COND	Condition
CONS	Continuous
CONST	Construction *or* constructed
CONT	Continue(s) *or* continued
COOR	Co-ordinate *or* coordination
COORD	Coordinates
COP	Change over point

COR	Correct *or* correction *or* corrected *(used to indicate corrected meteorological message; message type designator)*
COT	At the coast
COV	Cover *or* covered *or* covering
CPDLC‡	Controller-pilot data link communications
CPL	Current flight plan *(message type designator)*
CRC	Cyclic redundancy check
CRM	Collision risk mode!
CRP	Compulsory reporting point
CRZ	Cruise
CS	Call Sign
CS	Cirrostratus
CTA	Control area
CTAM	Climb to and maintain
CTC	Contact
CTL	Control
CTN	Caution
CTR	Control zone
CU	Cumulus
CUF	Cumuliform
CUST	Customs
CVR	Cockpit voice recorder
CW	Continuous wave
CWY	Clearway

D

... D~	DME Distance
D	Downward *(tendency In RVR during previous 10 minutes)*
D...	Danger area *(followed by Identification) (see FAD)~*
DA	Decision attitude
D-ATIS†	*(to be pronounced "DEE-ATIS")* Data link automatic terminal information service
DA/H~	Decision altitude/height
DAME~	Designated aviation medical examiner
DCD	Double channel duplex
DCKG	Docking
DCP	Datum crossing point
DCPC	Direct controller-pilot communications
DCS	Double channel simplex
DCT	Direct *(in relation to flight plan clearances and type of approach)*
DE*	From *(used to precede the call sign of the calling station) (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
DEC	December
DEC~	From *(used to precede the call sign of the calling station) (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
DEG	Degrees
DEP	Depart *or* departure
DEP	Departure *(message type designator)*
DEPO	Deposition
DER	Departure end of the runway
DES	Descend to *or* descending to
DEST	Destination
DETRESFA†	Distress phase
DEV	Deviation *or* deviating
DF	Direction finding
DFDR	Digital flight data recorder
DFTI	Distances from touchdown indicator

DH	Decision height
DIA~	Diameter
DIF	Diffuse
DIST	Distance
DIV	Divert *or* diverting
DLA	Delay *or* delayed
DLA	Delay *(message type designator)*
DLIC	Data link initiation capability
DLY	Daily
DME‡	Distance measuring equipment
DNG	Danger or dangerous
DOF	Date of flight
DOD~	Department of Defence
DOM	Domestic
DOT~	Department of Transport
DP	Dew point temperature
DPT	Depth
DR	Dead reckoning
DR ...	Low drifting *(followed by DU=dust, SA-sand or SN=snow)*
DRG	During
DS	Duststorm
DSB	Double sideband
DTAM	Descend to and maintain
DTG	Date-time group
DTHR	Displaced runway threshold
DTRT	Deteriorate *or* deteriorating
DTW	Dual tandem wheels
DU	Dust
DUC	Dense upper cloud
DUPE#	This is a duplicate message *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
DUR	Duration
D-VOLMET	Data link VOLMET
DVOR	Doppler VOR
DW	Dual wheels
DZ	Drizzle

E

E	East *or* eastern longitude
EAT	Expected approach time
EB	Eastbound
EDA	Elevation differential area
EDTO	Extended diversion time operations
EEE#	Error *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
EET	Estimated elapsed time
EFC	Expect further clearance
EFIS†	*(to be pronounced "EE-FIS")* Electronic flight instrument system
eFPL	Filed flight plan exchanged via flight and flow - information for a collaborative environment (FF-ICE) services
EGNOS†	*(to be pronounced "EGG-NOS")* European geostationary overlay service
EHF	Extremely high frequency [30000 to 300000 MHz]
EL/REIL~	Runway end lights/Runway end identifier lights.
ELBA†	Emergency location beacon - aircraft
ELEV	Elevation
ELR	Extra long range
ELT	Emergency locator transmitter
EM	Emission
EMBD	Embedded in a layer *(to Indicate cumulonimbus embedded in layers of other clouds)*
EMERG	Emergency

END	Stop-end *(related to RVR)*
ENE	East-north-east
ENG	Engine
ENR	En route
ENRC...	Enroute chart *(followed by name/ title)*
EOBT	Estimated off-block time
EQN	Equatorial latitudes northern hemisphere
EQPT	Equipment
EQS	Equatorial latitudes southern hemisphere
EROPS~	Extended range operations
ESE	East-south-east
EST	Estimate *or* estimated *or* estimation *(message type designator)*
ETA*‡	Estimated time of arrival *or* estimating arrival
ETD‡	Estimated time of departure *or* estimating departure
ETO	Estimated time over significant point
ETOPS~	Extended range operations with twin-engine aircraft
EUR RODEX	European regional OPMET data exchange
EV	Every
EVS	Enhanced vision system
EXC	Except
EXER	Exercises *or* exercising *or* to exercise
EXP	Expert *or* expected *or* expecting
EXTD	Extend *or* extending *or* Extended
F	
F	Fixed
F~	Sequenced flashing lights
FA	Course from a fix to an altitude
FAC	Facilities
FAD~	Danger Area *(South Africa)*
FAF	Final approach fix
FAL	Facilitation of international air transport
FAP	Final approach point
FAP~	Prohibited area *(South Africa)*
FAR~	Restricted area *(South Africa)*
FAS	Final approach segment
FATO	Final approach and take-off area
FAX	Facsimile transmission
FBL	Light *(used to indicate the Intensity of weather phenomena, Interference or static reports, e.g. FBL RA = light rain)*
FC	Funnel cloud *(tornado or water spout)*
FCST	Forecast
FCT	Friction coefficient
FDPS	Flight data processing system
FEB	February
FEW	Few
FG	Fog
FIC	Fight Information centre
FIR‡	Flight Information region
FIS	Flight Information service
FISA	Automated flight information service
FL	Flight level
FLD	Field
FLG	Flashing
FLO~	Floodlights
FLR	Flares
FLT	Flight
FLTCK	Flight check

FLUC	Fluctuating or fluctuation *or* fluctuated
FLW	Follow(s) *or* following
FLY	Fly *or* flying
FM	Course from a fix to manual termination *(used in navigation database coding)*
FM	From
FM...	From *(followed by time weather change is forecast to begin)*
FMC	Flight management computer
FMS‡	Flight management system
FMU	Flow management unit
FNA	Final approach
FPAP	Flight path alignment point
FPL	Filed flight plan exchanged via aeronautical fixed service (AFS)
FPM	Feet per minute
FPR	Flight plan route
FPU~	Filed flight plan *(message type designator)*
FR	Fuel remaining
FREQ	Frequency
FRI	Friday
FRNG	Firing
FRONT†	Front *(relating to weather)*
FROST†	Frost *(used In aerodrome warnings)*
FRQ	Frequent
FS~	French standard *(Angle of approach)*
FSL	Full stop landing
FSS	Flight service station
FST	First
FT	Feet *(dimensional unit)*
FTA~	Flight training area
FTE	Flight technical error
FTP	Fictitious threshold point
FTT	Flight technical tolerance
FU	Smoke
FZ	Freezing
FZDZ	Freezing drizzle
FZFG	Freezing fog
FZRA	Freezing rain

G

G	Green
G...	Variations from the mean wind speed (gusts) *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI and TAF)*
GA	Go ahead, resume sending *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
GA	General aviation
G/A	Ground-to-air
G/A/G	Ground-to-air and air-to-ground
GAGAN†	GPS and geostationary earth orbit augmented navigation
GAIN	Airspeed or headwind gain
GAMET	Area forecast for low-level flights
GARP	GBAS azimuth reference point
GBAS†	*(to be pronounced "GEE-BAS")* Ground-based augmentation system
GCA‡	Ground controlled approach system *or* ground controlled approach
GEN	General
GEO	Geographic *or* true
GES	Ground earth station
GLD	Glider
GLONASS†	*(to be pronounced “GLO-NAS”)* Global orbiting navigation satellite system

GLS‡	GBAS landing system
GMC...	Ground movement chart *(followed by name /title)*
GND	Ground
GNDCK	Ground check
GNSS‡	Global navigation satellite system
GOV	Government
GP	Glide path
GPA	Global path angle
GPIP	Glide path intercept point
GPS‡	Global positioning system
GPU	Ground power unit
GPWS‡	Ground proximity warning system
GR~	Earth *(runway)*
GR	Hail
GRAS†	*(to be pronounced "GRASS")* Ground-based regional augmentation system
GRASS	Grass landing area
GRAV~	Gravel *(Runway)*
GRIB	Processed meteorological data in the form of grid point values expressed in binary form *(meteorological code)*
GRVL	Gravel
GS~	Grass (Runway)
GS	Ground speed
GS	Small hail and/or snow pellets
GUND	Geoid undulation
g/m^3~	Grams per cubic meter

H

H~	High intensity
H	High pressure area *or* the centre of high pressure
H...	Significant wave height *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI)*
H24	Continuous day and night service
HA	Holding/racetrack to an altitude
HAPI	Helicopter approach path indicator
HBN	Hazard beacon
HDF	High frequency direction-finding station
HDG	Heading
HEL	Helicopter
HF‡	High frequency [3 000 to 30 000 kHz]
HF	Holding/racetrack to a fix
HGT	Height *or* height above
HJ	Sunrise to sunset
HLDG	Holding
HLS	Helicopter landing site
HM	Holding/racetrack to a manual termination
HN	Sunset to sunrise
HNH	High latitudes northern hemisphere
HO	Service available to meet operational requirements
HOD~	Hours of duty
HOL	Holiday
HOSP	Hospital aircraft
HPA	Hectopascal
HLP	Heliport
HR	Hours
HS	Service available during hours of scheduled operations
HSH	High latitudes southern hemisphere
HST~	High speed turn-off lights
HUD	Head-up display
HUM	Humanitarian

HURCN	Hurricane
HVDF	High and very high frequency direction finding stations *(at the same location)*
HVY	Heavy
HVY	Heavy *(used to indicate the intensity of weather phenomena, e.g. HVY RA = heavy rain)*
HX	No specific working hours
HYR	Higher
HZ	Haze
HZ	Hertz *(cycle per second)*

I

IAC...	Instrument approach chart *(followed by name/title)*
IAF	Initial approach fix
IAL~	Instrument approach and landing chart
IALS~	Intermediate approach lighting system
IAO	In and out of clouds
IAP	instrument approach procedure
IAR	Intersection of air routes
IAS	Indicated air speed
IBN	Identification beacon
ICAO	International Civil Aviation Organization
ICE	Icing
ID	Identifier *or* Identify
IDENT†	Identification
IF	Intermediate approach fix
IFF	Identification friend/foe
IFR‡	Instrument flight rules
IGA	International general aviation
ILS‡	Instrument landing system
IM	Inner marker
IMC‡	Instrument meteorological conditions
IMG	Immigration
IMI*	Interrogation sign (question mark) *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
IMPR	Improve *or* improving
IMT	Immediate *or* immediately
INA	Initial approach
INBD	Inbound
INC	In cloud
INCORP	Incorporated
INCERFA†	Uncertainty phase
INFO†	Information
INOP	Inoperative
INP	If not possible
INPR	In progress
INS	Inertial navigation system
INSTL	Install *or* installed *or* installation
INSTR	Instrument
INT	Intersection
INTL	International
INTRG	Interrogator
INTRP	Interrupt *or* interruption *or* Interrupted
INTSF	Intensify *or* intensifying
INTST	Intensity
IR	Ice on runway
IRS	Inertial reference system
ISA	International standard atmosphere
ISB	Independent sideband
ISOL	Isolated

J

JAN	January
JTST	Jet stream
JUL	July
JUN	June
K	
KG	Kilograms
KHZ	Kilohertz
KIAS	Knots indicated airspeed
KM	Kilometres
KMH	Kilometres per hour
KPA	Kilopascal
KT	Knots
KW	Kilowatts
kg/cm2~	Kilograms per square centimetre
L	
...L	Left *(preceded by runway designation number to identify a parallel runway)*
L	Locator *(see LM, LO)*
L	Low intensity
L	Low pressure area *or* the centre of low pressure
L	Litre
LAM	Logical acknowledgement *(message type designator)*
LAN	Inland
LASS~	Lowveld Military Airspace Sector
LAT	Latitude
LB~	3 Bar VASI (Long bodied)
LCA	Local *or* locally *or* location *or* located
LCN~	Load classification number
LDA	Landing distance available
LDAH	Landing distance available, helicopter
LDG	Landing
LDI	Landing direction Indicator
LDIN~	Sequenced flashing lead in lights
LEN	Length
LF	Low frequency [30 to 300 kHz]
LGT	Light *or* lighting
LGTD	Lighted
LIH	Light intensity high
LIL	Light Intensity low
LIM	Light intensity medium
LINE	Line *(used in SIGMET)*
LM	Locator middle
LMT	Local mean time
LNAV†	*(to be pronounced "EL-NAV")* Lateral navigation
LNG	long *(used to indicate the type of approach desired or required)*
LO	Locator, outer
LOC	Localizer
LONG	Longitude
LORAN†	LORAN *(long range air navigation system)*
LOSS	Airspeed or headwind loss
LPV	Localizer performance with vertical guidance
LR	The last message received by me was... *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
LRG	Long range
LS	The last message sent by me was.... or Last message was... *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
LTA	Lower control area
LTD	Limited
LTP	Landing threshold point

LV	Light and variable *(relating to wind)*
LVE	Leave *or* leaving
LVL	Level
LVP	Low visibility procedures
LYR	Layer *or* layered
M	
M~	Medium intensity
...M	Metres *(preceded by figures)*
M...	Mach number *(followed by figures)*
M...	Minimum value of runway visual range *(followed by figures In METAR/SPECI)*
MAA	Maximum authorized altitude
MAG	Magnetic
MAHF	Missed approach holding fix
MAINT	Maintenance
MALS~	Medium intensity approach system. May be installed with sequenced flashing lights (MALSF) or runway alignment indicator lights (MALSR).
MAP	Aeronautical maps and charts
MAPT	Missed approach point
MAR	At sea
MAR	March
MATF	Missed approach turning fix
MATZ	Military aerodrome traffic zone
MAX	Maximum
MAY	May
MBST	Microburst
MCA	Minimum crossing altitude
MCM	Maximum certified mass
MCTR	Military control zone
MCW	Modulated continuous wave
MDA	Minimum descent altitude
MDA/H~	Minimum descent altitude/height
MDF	Medium frequency direction-finding station
MDH	Minimum descent height
MEA	Minimum en-route altitude
MEDEVAC	Medical evacuation flight
MEHT	Minimum eye height over threshold *(for visual approach slope indicator system)*
MEL~	Minimum equipment list
MET†	Meteorological *or* meteorology
METAR†	Aerodrome routine meteorological report *(in meteorological code)*
MET REPORT	Local routine meteorological report *(in abbreviated plain language)*
MF	Medium frequency [300 kHz to 3000 kHz]
MHA	Minimum holding altitude
MHDF	Medium and high frequency direction-finding stations *(at the same location)*
MHVDF	Medium, high and very high frequency direction-finding station *(at the same location)*
MHZ	Megahertz
MID	Mid-point *(related to RVR)*
MIFG	Shallow fog
MIL	Military
MIN*	Minutes
MIS	Missing... *(transmission identification) (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
MKR	Marker radio beacon
MLS‡	Microwave landing system
MM	Middle marker

MNH	Middle latitudes northern hemisphere
MNM	Minimum
MNPS	Minimum navigation performance specifications
MNT	Monitor *or* monitoring *or* monitored
MNTN	Maintain
MOA	Military operating area
MOC	Minimum obstacle clearance *(required)*
MOCA	Minimum obstacle clearance altitude
MOD	Moderate *(used to indicate the intensity of weather phenomena, interference or static reports e.g, MODRA - moderate rain)*
MON	Above-mountains
MON	Monday
MOPS†	Minimum operational performance standards
MOV	Move *or* moving *or* movement
MPS	Meters per second
MRA	Minimum reception altitude.
MRG	Medium range
MRP	ATS/MET reporting point
MS	Minus
MSA	Minimum sector altitude
MSAS†	*(to be pronounced "EM-SAS")* Multifunctional transport satellite (MTSAT) satellite-based augmentation system
MSAW	Minimum safe altitude warning
MSG	Message
MSH	Middle latitudes southern hemisphere
MSL	Mean sea level
MSR#	Message... *(transmission identification)* has been misrouted *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
MSSR	Monopulse secondary surveillance radar
MT	Mountain
MTOM	Maximum take-off mass
MTU	Metric units
MTW	Mountain waves
MUNICIP~	Municipality, Town Council, etc.
MVDF	Medium and very high frequency direction-finding station *(at the same location)*
MWO	Meteorological watch office
MX	Mixed type of ice formation *(white and clear)*

N

N	No distinct tendency *(in RVR during previous 10 minutes)*
N	North *or* northern latitude
NA~	Not authorized
NADP	Noise abatement departure procedure
NASC†	National AIS system centre
NAT	North Atlantic
NAV	Navigation
NAVAID	Navigation aid
NB	North bound
NBFR	Not before
NC	No change
NCD	No cloud detected *(used in automated METAR/SPECI)*
NDB‡	Non-directional Radio Beacon
NDV	No directional variations available *(used in automated METAR/ SPECI)*

NE	North-east
NEB	North-eastbound
NEG	No *or* negative *or* permission not granted *or* that is not correct
NGT	Night
NIL*†	None *or* I have nothing to send to you
NM	Nautical miles
NML	Normal
NN	No name, unnamed
NNE	North north-east
NNW	North north-west
NO	No (negative) *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
NOF	International NOTAM office
NONSTD	Non-standard
NOSIG†	No significant change *(used in trend-type landing forecasts)*
NOTAM†	A notice distributed by means of telecommunication containing information concerning the establishment, condition or change in any aeronautical facility, service, procedure or hazard, the timely knowledge of which is essential to personnel concerned with flight operations
NOTAMC	Cancelling NOTAM
NOTAMN	New NOTAM
NOTAMR	Replacing NOTAM
NOV	November
NOZ‡	Normal operating zone
NPA	Non precision approach
NR	Number
NRH	No reply heard
NS	Nimbostratus
NSC	Nil significant cloud
NSE	Navigation system error
NSW	Nil significant weather
NTL	National
NTZ‡	No transgression zone
NW	North-west
NWB	North-westbound
NXT	Next

O

(O)~	Omni-directional
O~	Oil
OAC	Oceanic area control centre
OAS	Obstacle assessment surface
OBS	Observe *or* observed *or* observation
OBSC	Obscure *or* obscured *or* obscuring
OBST	Obstacle
OCA	Obstacle clearance altitude
OCA	Oceanic control area
OCC	Occulting *(light)*
OCH	Obstacle clearance height
OCNL	Occasional *or* occasionally
OCS	Obstacle clearance surface
OCT	October
ODALS~	Omni-directional sequenced flashing lead in lights.
OFZ	Obstacle free zone
OGN	Originate (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)
OHD	Overhead
OIS	Obstacle identification surface
OK*	We agree *or* it is correct (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)
OLDI†	On-line data Interchange
OM	Out marker

OPA	Opaque, white type of ice formation
OPC	Control indicated is operational control
OPMET†	Operational meteorological *(information)*
OPN	Open *or* opening *or* opened
OPR	Operator *or* operate *or* operative *or* operating *or* operational
OPS†	Operations
O/R	On request
ORD	Order
OSV	Ocean station vessel
OTH~	Other
OTP	On top
OTS	Organized track system
OUBD	Out-bound
OVC	Overcast
P	
P...	Maximum value of wind speed or runway visual range *(followed by METAR/SPECI and TAF)*
P...	Prohibited area *(followed by identification)*
P~	Precision approach path indicator
PA	Precision approach
PALS	Precision approach lighting system *(specify category)*
PANS	Procedures for air navigation services
PAPI†	Precision approach path indicator
PAR‡	Precision approach radar
PARL	Parallel
PATC...	Precision approach terrain chart *(followed by name/title)*
PAX	Passenger(s)
PB~	Private Bag
PBC	Performance-based communication
PBE~	Portable breathing equipment
PBN	Performance-based navigation
PBS	Performance-based surveillance
PC~	Contingency procedures
PCD	Proceed *or* proceeding
PCL	Pilot-controlled lighting
PCN	Pavement classification number
PCR	Pavement classification rating
PCT	Per cent
PDC‡	Pre-departure clearance
PDG	Procedure design gradient
PER	Performance
PERM	Permanent
PF~	Paraffin Flares
PFP	Preliminary flight plan
PIB	Pre-flight Information bulletin
PJE	Parachute jumping exercise
PL	Ice pellets
PLA	Practice low approach
PLVL	Present level
PN	Prior notice required
PNR	Point of no return
PO	Dust devils/sand whirl (dust devil)
POB	Persons on board
POSS	Possible
PPI	Plan position Indicator
PPR	Prior permission required
PPSN	Present position
PRFG	Aerodrome partially covered by fog
PRI	Primary
PRIV~	Aerodrome licensed in Private category

PRKG	Parking
PROB†	Probability
PROC	Procedure
PROP	Propeller
PROV	Provisional
PRP	Point-in-space reference, point
PS	Plus
PSG	Passing
PSI~	Pounds per square inch
PSN	Position
PSP	Pierced steel plank
PSR‡	Primary surveillance radar
PSYS	Pressure system(s)
PTN	Procedure turn
PTS	Polar track structure
PUB~	Aerodrome licensed in the public category
PWR	Power

Q

QDL~	Do you intend to ask me for a series of bearings? or I intend to ask you for a series of bearings *(to be used in radiotelephony as a Q code)*
QDM‡	Magnetic heading *(zero wind)*
QDR	Magnetic, bearing
QFE‡	Atmospheric pressure at aerodrome elevation *(or at runway threshold)*
QFU	Magnetic orientation of runway
QGE	What is my distance to your station? *or* Your distance to my station is *(distance figures and units) (to be used in radiotelephony as a Q code)*
QJH	Shall I run my test tape/a test sentence? *or* Run your test tape/ a test sentence *(to be used in AFS as a Q code)*
QNE~	Indicated height on landing, with altimeter sub-scale set lo 1013,2 hectopascals
QNH‡	Altimeter sub-scale setting to obtain elevation when on the ground
QSP	Will you relay to... free of charge? *or* I will relay to... free of charge (*to be used in AFS as a Q code)*
QTA	Shall I cancel telegram number...? or Cancel telegram number (to be used in AFS as a Q code)
QTE	True bearing
QTF	Will you give me the position of my station according to the bearings taken by the D/F stations which you control? *or* The position of your station according to the bearings taken by the D/F stations that I control was...latitude...longitude (*or* other indication of position), class...at...hours *(to be used in radiotelegraphy as Q Code)*
QUAD	Quadrant
QUJ	Will you indicate the TRUE track to reach you? or The TRUE track to reach me is...degrees at... hours *(to be used in radiotelephony as a Q code)*

R

(R)~	VOR Radial
... R	Right *(preceded by runway designation number to identify a parallel runway)*
R	Rate of turn
R	Red

R...	Restricted area *(followed by identification)*
R ...	Runway *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI)*
R*	Received *(acknowledgement of receipt) (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
R...	Radial from VOR *(followed by three figures)*
R/T~	Radio Telephony
RA	Rain
RA	Resolution advisory
RAC	Rules of the air and air traffic services
RAFC~	Regional area forecast centre
RAG	Ragged
RAG	Runway arresting gear
RAI	Runway alignment Indicator
RAIL~	Runway alignment indicator lights *(always installed with other lighting systems.)*
RAIM†	Receiver autonomous integrity monitoring
RASC†	Regional AIS system centre
RASS	Remote altimeter setting source
RB	Rescue Boat
RCA	Reach cruising altitude
RCC	Rescue Co-ordination centre
RCF	Radiocommunication failure *(message type designator)*
RCH	Reach *or* reaching
RCL	Runway centre line
RCLL	Runway centre line light(s)
RCLR	Recleared
RCP‡	Required communication performance
RDOACT	Radioactive
Rd~	Red
RDH	Reference datum height
RDH~	Reference datum height (for ILS)
RDL	Radial
RDO	Radio
RE...	Recent *(used to qualify weather phenomena e.g. RERA - recent rain)*
REC	Receive *or* receiver
REDL	Runway edge light(s)
REF	Reference to... *or* refer to...
REG	Registration
REIL~	Runway end lights/Runway end identifier lights.
RENL	Runway end light(s)
REP	Report *or* reporting *or* reporting point
REQ	Request *or* requested
RERTE	Re-route
RESA	Runway end safety area
RF	Constant radius arc to a fix
RFFS	Rescue and fire services
RG	Range *(lights)*
RHC	Right-hand circuit
RIF	Reclearance in flight
RIME†	Rime *(used in aerodrome warnings)*
RL	Report leaving
RL~	Runway edge lights
RLA	Relay to
RLCE	Request level change en-route
RLLS	Runway lead-in lighting system
RLNA	Requested level not available
RMK	Remark
RNAV†	*(to be pronounced "AR-NAV")* Area navigation

RNG	Radio range
RNP‡	Required navigation performance
ROBEX†	Regional OPMET bulletin exchange *(scheme)*
ROC	Rate of climb
ROD	Rate of descent
ROLL~	Runway centre line light(s)
RON	Receiving only
RPDS	Reference path data selector
RPI‡	Radar position indicator
RPL	Repetitive flight plan
RPLC	Replace *or* replaced
RPS	Radar position symbol
RPT*	Repeat *or* I repeat *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
RQ*	Request *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
RQ~	Indication of a request *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
RQMNTS	Requirements
RQP	Request flight plan *(message type designator)*
RQS	Request supplementary flight plan *(message type designator)*
RR	Report reaching
RRA	*(or RRB, RRC...etc in sequence)* Delayed meteorological message *(message type designator)*
RSA~	Republic of South Africa
RSC	Rescue sub-centre
RSCD	Runway surface condition
RSP‡	Required surveillance performance
RSP	Responder beacon
RSR	En-route surveillance radar
RSS	Root sum square
RTD	Delayed *(used to indicate delayed meteorological message; message type designator)*
RTE	Route
RTF	Radiotelephone
RTG	Radiotelegraph
RTHL	Runway threshold light(s)
RTN	Return *or* returned *or* returning
RTODAH	Rejected take-off distance available, helicopter
RTS	Return to service
RTT	Radio teletypewriter
RTZL	Runway touchdown zone light(s)
RUT	Standard regional route transmitting frequencies
RV	Rescue vessel
RVA	Radar vectoring area
RVR‡	Runway visual range
RVSM‡	Reduced vertical separation minimum (300 m (1000 ft) between FL 290 and FL 410
RWY	Runway
S	
S	South *or* southern latitude
S...	State of the sea *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI)*
S~	Standard VASI
S~	Strobes
S1~	Hangarage
S2~	Hangarage and minor aircraft repairs
S3~	Hangarage, minor aircraft repairs and minor engine repairs
S4~	Hangarage, major aircraft repairs and minor engine repairs
S5~	Hangarage, major aircraft repairs and engine repairs

SA	Sand
SACAA~	South African Civil Aviation Authority
SA-CARS~	South African Civil Aviation Regulations
SALS~	Short approach light system. May be installed with sequenced flashing lights (SALSF) or runway alignment indicator lights (SALSR)
SALS	Simple approach lighting system
SAN	Sanitary
SAND~	Sandy soil
SANDF~	South African National Defence Force
SAPS~	South African Police Service
SAR	Search and rescue
SARPS	Standards and Recommended Practices [ICAO]
SAT	Saturday
SATCOM†	Satellite communication *(used only when referring generally to both voice and data satellite communication or only data satellite communication)*
SATVOICE †	Satellite voice communication
SB	Southbound
SBAS†	*(to be pronounced "ESS-BAS")* Satellite-based augmentation system
SC	Stratocumulus
SCT	Scattered
Sd~	Sodium
SD	Standard deviation
SDBY	Stand by
SDF	Step down fix
SE	South-east
SEA	Sea *(used in connection with sea surface temperature and state of the sea)*
SEB	South-Eastbound
SEC	Seconds
SECN	Section
SECT	Sector
SELCAL†	Selective calling system
SEP	September
SER	Service *or* servicing *or* served
SEV	Severe *(used e.g. to qualify icing and turbulence reports)*
SFC	Surface
SG	Snow grains
SGL	Signal
SH …	Shower *(followed by RA = rain, SN = snow, PL = ice pellets, GR = hail, GS = small hail and/or snow pellets or combinations thereof, e.g. SHRASN = showers of rain and snow)*
SHF	Super high frequency [3 000 to 30 000 MHz]
SI	International system of units
SID†	Standard instrument departure
SIF	Selective identification feature
SIG	Significant
SIGMET†	information concerning en-route weather and other phenomena in the atmosphere that may affect the safety of aircraft operations
SIMUL	Simultaneous *or* simultaneously
SITA~	Societe international de Telecommunication Aeronautique *(a private satellite communication system)*
SIWL	Single isolated wheel load
SKED	Schedule or scheduled
SLP	Speed limiting point

SLW	Slow
SMC	Surface movement control
SMR	Surface movement radar
SN	Snow
SNOCLO	Aerodrome closed due to snow *(used in the METAR/SPECI)*
SNOWTAM †	A special series NOTAM notifying the presence or removal of hazardous conditions due to snow, ice, slush or standing water associated with snow, slush and ice on the movement area, by means of a specific format
SOC	Start of climb
SPECI†	Aerodrome special meteorological report (in meteorological code)
SPECIAL†	Local special meteorological report *(in abbreviated plain language)*
SPI	Special position indicator
SPL	Supplementary flight plan *(message type designator)*
SPOC	SAR point of contact
SPOT†	Spot wind
SQ	Squall
SQL	Squall line
SR	Sunrise
SRA	Surveillance radar approach
SRE	Surveillance radar element of precision approach radar system
SRG	Short range
SRR	Search and rescue region
SRY	Secondary
SS	Sandstorm
SS	Sunset
SSALS~	Simplified short approach light system. May be installed with sequenced flashing lights (SSALS) or runway alignment indicator lights (SSALR)
SSB	Single sideband
SSE	South-south-east
SSR‡	Secondary surveillance radar
SST	Supersonic transport
SSW	South-south-west
ST	Stratus
STA	Straight-in approach
STAR†	Standard instrument arrival route
STD	Standard
STF	Stratiform
STN	Station
STNR	Stationary
STOL	Short take-off and landing
STS	Status
STWL	Stopway light(s)
SUBJ	Subject to
SUN	Sunday
SUP	Supplement *(AIP Supplement)*
SUPPS	Regional supplementary procedures
SVC	Service *(message type only)*
SVCBL	Serviceable
SW	South-west
SWB	South-westbound
SWX	Space weather
SWXC	Space weather centre
SWY	Stopway
T	
T~	"T" Type
T	Temperature

...T	True *(preceded by a bearing to indicate reference to True North)*
TA	Traffic advisory
TA	Transition altitude
TAA	Terminal arrival altitude
TACAN†	UHF tactical air navigation aid
TAF†	Aerodrome forecast *(in meteorological code)*
TA/H	Turn at an altitude/height
TAIL†	Tail, wind
TAR	Terminal area surveillance radar
TAS	True airspeed
TAX	Taxiing *or* taxi
TC	Tropical cyclone
TCAC	Tropical cyclone advisory centre
TCAS RA†	*(to be pronounced "TEE-CAS-AR-AY")* Traffic alert and collision avoidance system resolution advisory
TCH	Threshold crossing height
TCU	Towering cumulus
TDO	Tornado
TDZ	Touchdown zone
TECR	Technical reason
TEL	Telephone
TEMPO†	Temporary *or* temporarily
TF	Track to fix
TF~	Turbine Fuel
TFC	Traffic
TGL	Touch-and-go landing
TGS	Taxiing guidance system
THR	Threshold
THRU	Through
THU	Thursday
TIBA†	Traffic information broadcast by aircraft
TIL†	Until
TIP	Until past...*(place)*
TKOF	Take-off
TL...	Till *(followed by time by which weather change is forecast to end)*
TLOF	Touchdown and lift-off area
TMA‡	Terminal control area
TMM~	Transmissometer
TN...	Minimum temperature *(followed by figures in TAF)*
TNA	Turn altitude
TNH	Turn height
TO...	To...*(place)*
TOC	Top of climb
TODA	Take-off distance available
TODAH	Take-off distance available, helicopter
TOP†	Cloud top
TORA	Take-off run available
TOX	Toxic
TP	Turning point
TPI~	Traffic Pattern Indicator
TR	Track
TRA	Temporary reserved airspace
TRANS	Transmits *or* transmitter
TREND†	Trend forecast
TRL	Transition level
TRG	Training
TROP	Tropopause
TS	Thunderstorm *(in aerodrome reports and forecasts, TS used alone means thunder heard but no precipitation at the aerodrome)*

TS...	Thunderstorm *(followed by RA = rain, SN = snow, PL = ice pellets, GR = hail, GS = small hair and/or snow pellets or combinations thereof e.g. TSRASN = thunderstorm with rain and snow)*
TSO*	Technical Standard Order
TSUNAMI†	Tsunami *(used in aerodrome warnings)*
TT	Teletypewriter
TUE	Tuesday
TURB	Turbulence
T-VASIS†	*(to be pronounced "TEE-VASIS")* T visual approach slope indicator systems
TVOR	Terminal VOR
TWR	Aerodrome control tower *or* Aerodrome control
TWY	Taxiway
TX	Maximum temperature *(followed by figures in TAF)*
TXL	Taxilane
TXT*	Text *(when the abbreviation is used to request a repetition, the question mark (IMI) precedes the abbreviation, e.g. IMI TXT) (to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
TYP	Type of aircraft
TYPH	Typhoon
U	
(u)~	Uni-directional
U	Upward *(tendency in RVR during previous 10 minutes)*
UA	Unmanned aircraft
UAB	Until advised by...
UAC	Upper area control centre
UAR	Upper air route
UAS	Unmanned aircraft system
UDF	Ultra high frequency direction-finding station
UFN	Until further notice
UHDT	Unable higher due traffic
UHF‡	Ultra high frequency [300 to 3000 MHz]
UIC	Upper information centre
UIR‡	Upper flight Information region
ULM	Ultra light motorized aircraft
ULR	Ultra long range
UNA	Unable
UNAP	Unable to approve
UNL	Unlimited
UNREL	Unreliable
UP	Unidentified precipitation *(used in automated METAR/SPECI)*
U/S	Unserviceable
UTA	Upper control area
UTC‡	Coordinated Universal Time
V	
V~	High intensity
V	Variations from the mean wind direction *(preceded and followed by figures in METAR/SPECI, e.g. 350V070)*
VA	Heading to an altitude
VA	Volcanic ash
VAAC	Volcanic ash advisory centre
VAC	Visual approach chart *(followed by name/title)*
VAL	In valleys
VAN	Runway control van
VAR	Magnetic variation
VAR	Visual-aural radio range

VASIS	Visual approach slope indicator system
VC...	Vicinity of the Aerodrome *(followed by FG = fog, FC = funnel cloud, SH = shower, PO = dust/sand whirls, BLDU = blowing dust, BLSA = blowing sand, BLSN = blowing snow, DS = duststorm, SS = sandstorm, TS = thunderstorm or VA = volcanic ash, e.g. VCFG = vicinity fog)*
VCCS~	Voice Control Communication System
VCY	Vicinity
VDF	Very high frequency direction-finding station
VER	Vertical
VFR‡	Visual flight rules
VHF‡	Very high frequency (30 to 300 MHz)
VI	Heading to an intercept
VIP‡	Very important person
VIS	Visibility
VLF	Very low frequency [3 to 30 kHz]
VLR	Very long range
VM	Heading to a manual termination
VMC‡	Visual meteorological conditions
VNAV†	*(to be pronounced "VEE-NAV")* Vertical navigation
VOL	Volume (followed by I, II...)
VOLMET†	Meteorological information for aircraft in flight
VOR‡	VHF omnidirectional radio range
VORTAC†	VOR and TACAN combination
VOT	VOR airborne equipment test facility
VPA	Vertical path angle
VPT	Visual manoeuvre with prescribed track
VRB	Variable
VSA	By visual reference to the ground
VSP	Vertical speed
VTF	Vector to final
VTOL	Vertical take-off and landing
VV...	Vertical visibility *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI and TAF)*

W

W	West *or* western longitude
W	White
W...	Sea-surface temperature *(followed by figures in METAR/SPECI)*
W~	Watt
WAAS†	Wide area augmentation system
WAC	World Aeronautical Chart-ICAO 1:1 000 000 *(followed by name/title)*
WAFC	World area forecast centre
WB	Westbound
WB~	Wing bar *(lights always green unless specified)*
WBAR	Wing bar lights
WDI	Wind direction indicator
WDSPR	Widespread
WED	Wednesday
WEF	With effect from *or* effective from
WGS-84	World Geodetic System - 1984
WH~	Blasting
WI	Within
WID	Width *or* wide
WIE	With immediate effect *or* effective immediately
WILCO†	Will comply
WIND	Wind

WIP	Work in progress
WKN	Weaken *or* weakening
WNW	West-north-west
WO	Without
WPT	Way-point
WRNG	Warning
WS	Wind shear
WSPD	Wind speed
WSW	West-south-west
WT	Weight
WTSPT	Waterspout
WWW	Worldwide web
WX	Weather
WXR	Weather radar
X	
X	Cross
XBAR	Crossbar *(of approach lighting system)*
XNG	Crossing
XS	Atmospherics
Y	
Y	Yellow
YCZ	Yellow caution zone *(runway lighting)*
YES*	Yes (affirmative) *(to be used in AFS as a procedure signal)*
YR	Your
Z	
Z	Coordinated Universal Time *(in meteorological messages)*

LIST OF DEFINITIONS/GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Calendar:	Discrete temporal reference system that provides the basis for defining temporal position to a resolution of one day (ISO 19108).
Geoid:	The equipotential surface in the gravity field of the Earth which coincides with the undisturbed mean sea level (MSL) extended continuously through the continents.
Geoid undulation:	The distance of the geoid above (positive) or below (negative) the mathematical reference ellipsoid.
Gregorian calendar:	Calendar in general use; first introduced in 1582 to define a year that more closely approximates the tropical year than the Julian calendar (ISO 19108).
Aeronautical Information Product	Aeronautical data and aeronautical information provided either as digital data sets or as a standardized presentation in paper or electronic media. Aeronautical information products include: AIP, including amendments and supplements; AIC; aeronautical charts; NOTAM and digital data sets.
Logon address:	A specified code used for data link logon to an ATS unit.
Portrayal:	Presentation of information to humans (ISO 19117).
Precision:	The smallest difference that can be reliably distinguished by a measurement process.
Route stage:	A route or portion of a route flown without an intermediate landing.
Station declination	An alignment variation between the zero degree radial of a VOR and true north, determined at the time the VOR station is calibrated.